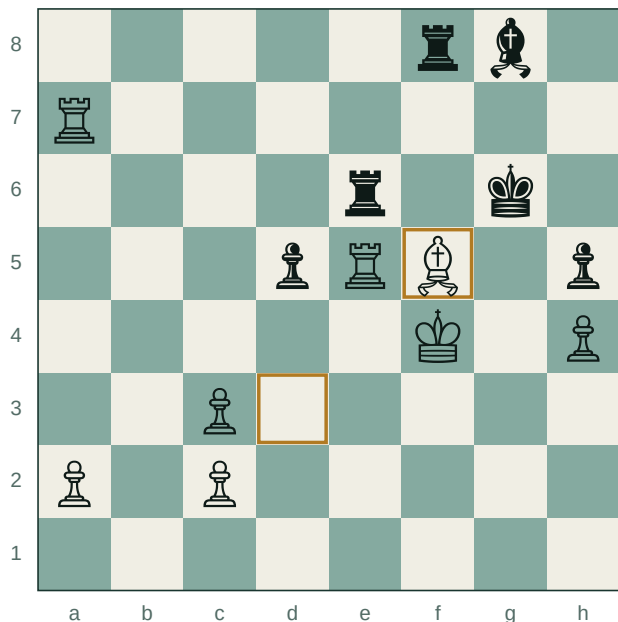


Calculated sacrifices: Black, move 41

Calculated sacrifices

Black to move



Previous move: 41.Bxf5+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

41...Rxf5+ 42. Rxf5 Re4+ 43. Kf3 Kxf5

41...Rxf5+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. From f5 it attacks king on f4 and rook on e5. Recorded reply: **42.Rxf5**.

42...Re4+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **43.Kf3**.

43...Kxf5 The king captures the rook on f5.

At the end, nominal material is White 9 / Black 10 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from -2 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

An attractive attacking picture is not compensation by itself. Continue until the resulting position can be evaluated honestly.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A sacrifice exchanges material for a concrete benefit. The benefit may be mate, a stronger attack, a recovered investment, or lasting activity; it must be shown through moves.

HOW TO LOOK

State what the sacrifice changes: a defender, a line, a king square, or a critical tempo. Calculate acceptance and plausible refusal.

The defending king is on f4. Absolute pin: bishop on f5.